

Interview Guide



Welcome to your preparation guide for your interview at Meta! This guide will take you approximately 30 minutes to review. Use the table of contents below to quickly jump to the section you are looking for. Whether you’re taking your initial screen or your full loop interview, our Reality Labs leaders and recruiters put together this guide so you know what to expect and how to prepare. We recognize that interviewing can be stressful, so we hope this guide provides the information and resources you need. Remember, your recruiter is there to support you, so please reach out to them with any questions.

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Accommodations process

Meta is committed to providing reasonable support (called accommodations) in our recruiting processes for qualified candidates with disabilities, physical conditions, mental health conditions, neurodivergence, sincerely held religious beliefs, pregnancy, childbirth, or related

medical conditions, as required by law. If you need assistance or require an accommodation, reach out via the [Accommodations request form](#).

Team introduction

Reality Labs at Meta is building products that make it easier for people to connect with the ones they love most, enjoy top-notch, wire-free MR, and push the future of computing platforms. We are a team of world-class experts developing and shipping products at the intersection of hardware, software and content.

Interview process overview

This guide will explain what to expect during your interviews with Meta. As part of your interview, you will have the opportunity to meet with peers, cross-functional partners, and other leaders at Meta. Your recruiter will be your guide throughout the process and aim to adequately prepare you to bring your best self to your interview.

What will your interview process be?

Your interview process will include five to six 45 minute interviews; each interview will try to leave a few minutes at the end for your questions. You can expect the following interviews in the Full Loop round:

- Coding (2 minimum)
- Behavioral (1 minimum)
- In-Domain Design (1 minimum)
- System Design or Product Architecture (1 minimum)
- Potential for 1 additional round of one of these categories (randomized)

Video Conference interview best practices

- Make sure you're in a quiet environment.
- Double check that you have a reliable internet/phone connection.
- It's okay to ask the person you're speaking with to speak slowly if you can't catch what they're saying.
- You'll need a laptop with a webcam, speaker, and mic. We recommend using a headset or headphones with a mic for better quality audio, but this is optional.
- While we embrace the usage of advanced tooling in our day-to-day work to build the future of social connection, we ask that you not use any unauthorized outside assistance during interviews. Throughout the interview process you may be asked to share your screen via Zoom. Here you can find [guidance](#) on how this works. Additionally, we ask that you disable and not use filters during your interview. This will help us get an understanding of how you approach problem-solving and coding independently. Outside assistance includes, but is not limited to, consulting external resources, seeing help from others, or using AI tools, like ChatGPT.

- For your interview, ensure Zoom screen sharing is enabled in advance, as setup may require a few minutes. Here's how: [Enable Zoom screen share](#).
- A filter is considered any tool/feature that applies visual effects to your video feed, including virtual/blurred background.

Interview Dress Code

As you're probably aware, we promote a casual environment at Meta so that everyone can be their authentic selves. Formal dress is not required (jeans are definitely ok!). Dress comfortably. We care about what you can do, not what you wear.

Coding

What can you expect?

There will be a minimum of two interviews focused on coding. You'll be assessed on how you solve the problem as well as the structure and style of your code. Additionally, we want to hear your thought process throughout, so be sure to provide a narrative as you solve and code up your solutions.

The language you will code in may vary depending upon the specific role for which you are interviewing (see below for a list of languages by role). Please confirm the coding language preference with your recruiter in advance.

- Audio, Camera, Compiler, and Embedded: C, C++
- Graphics: C++
- Gameplay and Realtime Engine: C#, C++
- OS Frameworks: C, C++, Java
- Security: C, C++, Rust, Java, Python
- Video: C, C++, Java

What do we look for?

Your interviewer will be thinking about how your skills and experience might help Meta as well as how you tackle problems you're not as familiar with. In your coding interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on four focus areas:

- **Communication:** Are you asking for requirements and clarity when necessary or are you just diving into the code? Your coding interview should be a conversation, so don't forget to ask questions and listen carefully to your interviewer.
- **Problem Solving:** How do you comprehend and explain complex ideas? Are you providing the reasoning behind a particular solution? Developing and comparing multiple solutions? Using appropriate data structures? Speaking about space and time complexity? Optimizing your solution?

- **Coding:** Can you convert solutions to executable code? Is the code organized and does it have the right logical structure?
- **Verification:** Are you considering a reasonable number of test cases or coming up with a good argument for why your code is correct? If your solution has bugs, are you able to walk through your own logic to find them and explain what the code is doing?

How to prep

Interviewers can only assess your skills and abilities based on what you show them during your interview, so it's important to plan and prepare to best showcase your strengths. As you begin preparing, please reference your Career Profile for additional role-specific prep materials, if available.

We use many different coding languages at Meta, so practice in the coding language noted based on your specific role or information that was provided by your recruiter.

You should expect to solve two problems in about 40 minutes. When you have a solution, be sure to review it. Make sure that it's correct, that you've considered the edge cases, that it's efficient, and that it clearly reflects the ideas that you're trying to express in your code.

In addition, these tips may be helpful:

- Schedule time to study and practice. Block out time every day to write code. You'll need to practice writing code without executing it - without the help of a compiler and debugger. This will simulate a timed interview environment.
- Analyze the problem and make sure that you fully understand it before jumping in. It's OK to ask clarifying questions during the interview to ensure you understand the exact problem you are trying to solve. Also, breaking down the problem into smaller pieces can be helpful.
- Ensure you balance both breadth and depth. Practice solving a range of example problems across problem types as well as different levels of complexity.
- Get comfortable with the medium you'll use in the interview. Meta uses CoderPad, a shared code editor, in remote coding interviews. We recommend doing a few practice questions with CoderPad so you're familiar with the basic functionality. Practice talking through a problem before you start coding. Your interviewer will be evaluating how you explore the problem space and weigh different possible solutions, so it's crucial to help the interviewer understand your choices.
- Keep things simple. If you find the solution getting excessively complex, step back and ask if there's a simpler way to solve it. It may also be helpful to write everything out so you can see insights and bugs faster and make fewer mistakes.

Behavioral

What can you expect?

Your interviewer will want to learn about your background, what you're passionate about in tech, and what kind

of impact you want to make.

What do we look for?

The purpose of the Behavioral interview is to assess if a candidate will thrive in Meta's fast-paced and highly unstructured environment. To that end, we assess candidates on five signals that correlate with success at Meta:

- **Resolving Conflict:** What kind of disagreements have you had with colleagues and/or managers? How have you resolved them? Can you empathize with people whose points of view differ from yours?
- **Growing Continuously:** What's your aptitude for seeking out opportunities for growth and learning? Do you take constructive criticism as an opportunity to improve? How have you approached improving your skills?
- **Embracing Ambiguity:** How do you operate in an ambiguous and quickly changing environment? Are you comfortable making decisions and maintaining high levels of productivity when you are missing information or lack clarity? How did you react when you had to quickly pivot away from a project due to a shift in priority?
- **Driving Results:** What's your experience pushing yourself and others to deliver against goals and objectives. How do you demonstrate your impact? Are you self-directed in reaching goals despite challenges and roadblocks?
- **Communicating Effectively:** How well do you communicate with teams? What about cross-functional partners? How do you tailor your communications based on the work and/or the audience?
- We may ask you to:
 - Discuss available details of past and current projects.
 - Provide specific examples about what you did and the resulting impact.
 - Share what you learned from a past situation.
 - Talk about what you like about your current role and/or being a developer.

How to prep

Interviewers can only assess your skills and abilities based on what you show them during your interview, so it's important to plan and prepare to best showcase your strengths.

- **Know yourself.** Take the time to review your own résumé as your interviewer will almost certainly ask about key events in your work history. Be prepared to discuss projects in depth. It's helpful to outline 2-3 major projects ahead of time.
- **Be honest.** Not every project is a runaway success, and we may not always interact perfectly with our peers. Being transparent in these situations won't be counted against you in the interview. In fact, sharing & discussing how you learned, improved, and grew from your past experiences is valued. Share what you learned from a past situation.
- **Use the S.T.A.R. method** to mentally organize your thoughts. This will provoke a well-thought-out and chronological action of events. Easy to describe, easy to follow. You can practice this method using the Journaling Exercises in the Preparation Hub within your Career Profile.
 - **S**—One or two sentences about the SITUATION: What happened?

- **T**—Describe the TASK: What was your specific goal?
 - **A**—ACTIONS you took to overcome the obstacles and complete your objective.
 - **R**—The tangible / quantifiable RESULTS of the situation: How did it help the team / company?
- **Have concrete examples or anecdotes.** Support each question with practical experiences and examples. Avoid theoretical answers - if you go into a theoretical tangent, your interviewer will redirect you to provide a concrete example.

System Design and Product Architecture

What can you expect?

You may complete one of the below design interviews depending on the job you are applying for and your area of expertise. Confirm with your recruiter which interviews you need to prepare for and skip over information for interviews for which you do not need to prepare.

The System Design or Product Architecture interview is 45 minutes and does not involve coding. Instead, you'll spend the interview talking and using the virtual whiteboard as a visual aid (think: box and arrows diagrams, function signatures, or API specifications).

The purpose of the In Domain Design interview is to understand your thought process and approach through solving a technically specific design problem within your area of domain expertise. This interview also seeks to understand how you've applied your expertise in a specific domain to move design-based projects forward. If you come across a topic you're not familiar with, or the question seems vague, don't panic! Part of the interview assessment is on whether you can solve problems in an unfamiliar space with your existing domain knowledge.

What do we look for?

The purpose of these interviews is to assess your ability to solve a non-trivial engineering design problem. The interviewer is trying to determine if you can architect a solution to a higher-level problem that requires connecting multiple concepts. Questions will be somewhat high-level, and it will be up to you to drive the conversation. In these interviews, your interviewer will assess your performance on four focus areas:

- **Problem Navigation:** Do you demonstrate the ability to organize the problem space, the constraints, and the potential solutions? Ask questions to reduce ambiguity, identify the most critical problems, understand what is needed for quantitative analysis, and define the key requirements.
- **Solution Design:** Can you design a working solution that addresses either the complete problem/design or pieces of the problem/design. Are you able to consider the big picture in your design?
- **Technical Excellence:** Can you dive into the technical details when needed? Can you identify and articulate the dependencies and trade-offs? How are you mitigating potential risks and failure points?
- **Technical Communication:** Can you articulate your vision and technical ideas clearly? We are assessing your ability to communicate your reasoning as well as understand and address feedback from the interviewer.

How to prep

This may be a challenging interview to prepare for given it is so interactive and there's no "right answer" for a design problem. Use the prep tips here and the resources listed in the appendix.

- **Meta uses Excalidraw**, a shared drawing and whiteboard tool, in remote design interviews. Make sure you're familiar with the basic functionality of Excalidraw before your interview. You should be able to quickly create and label a block diagram.
- **Start by reasoning through the requirements** necessary before reasoning through your design.
- **Don't be afraid to ask your interviewer clarifying questions** about the design question. It may be necessary to dig deeper before you can start providing an answer.
- **Improve upon a design**. Think about and review the complex systems you've already designed. What would you change about your approach if you did it all over again? What worked well?
- **Design from the ground up**. Think about how you'd design a system that Meta (or another large tech company) already has. It's a good exercise to think through the complicated, high-scale systems that you already use every day. How would you design it from scratch? What are the bottlenecks to your solution? How would you address them?
- **Keep in mind inherent tradeoffs**. Explore competing solutions and speak to their major tradeoffs. Demonstrate that you can make intelligent decisions about how to balance each of those tradeoffs.
- **Do some research**. Read engineering blogs about approaches that have worked for big companies along the way. For instance, Meta publishes an [engineering blog](#) that talks about the design of existing Meta systems. Read about the false-starts too!
- **Be holistic and detailed**. Practice moving from high-level information to the precise details. Outline the high-level requirements by describing what components you may need, how they fit together, and how to get to that solution.

Final tips for your interview

- **Be yourself**. This means being open and honest about your successes and ways you've improved throughout your career. Also, be sure to call out how you have specifically added value to your team or projects you've contributed to. We value teamwork and what each individual member brings to the table.
- **Carefully review and familiarize yourself with the job description and perform research on Meta and the role**. Be prepared to answer why you are interested in this specific role and in working at Meta.
- **Please take the time to review our [mission statement](#) and [core values](#)**. These values influence how we work together to fulfill our mission to build the future of human connection and the technology that makes it possible. We also encourage you to take time using our technologies such as Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, and WhatsApp.

- **One important piece of advice for your interviews: it's ok if you don't know!** No one who works at Meta is an expert in all things, and we don't look for perfection in the people we interview. If you aren't sure of something during your interview, you're encouraged to ask clarifying questions and be upfront if there are topics that you have less experience with.
- **Prepare thoughtful questions for the interviewer(s).** Your interviewer may challenge your ideas, and you should be ready to speak not only to what you recommend or have experienced but the why as well. It is important to think outside the box and to approach problems from creative and different perspectives.

Post interview – What to expect

You can expect your recruiter to provide a specific timeline or updates along the way. Your recruiter will inform you of next steps after your interview as soon as they are available. Feel free to follow up with them if you have not heard within a week of your interviews.

Appendix / Resources

Below is a curated list of resources to get started and help you prepare.

Meta resources

- [About Meta](#) website
- [Meta Newsroom](#) website
- [Meta Careers](#) website
- [Culture at Meta](#) website
- [Meta employee benefits](#) website
- [Interviewing at Meta: The keys to success](#) blog

Update personal information, track interview progress, and send thank you notes.

At any time during the interview process, you can track your progress, send thank-you notes and update your personal information all via the [Career Profile](#). If you do not receive a link from recruiting, you may create one.

Thank you for taking the time to review this guide!